

WordPress 2.8 claims to be snappier

Just a few days before we officially relaunched LinuxForU.com, which is powered by WordPress 2.7.1, Matt Mullenweg announced the release of version 2.8—talk

about bad timing. “2.8 represents a nice fit and finished release for WordPress with improvements to themes, widgets, taxonomies, and overall speed. We also fixed over 790 bugs,” Mullenweg announced.

According to the announcement, the new version is much faster than the older releases, in addition to changes in the way WordPress does styling and scripting. “If you make edits

or tweaks to themes or plugins from your dashboard, you’ll appreciate the new CodePress editor which gives syntax highlighting to the previously-plain editor. Also, there is now contextual documentation for the functions in the file you’re editing, linked right below the editor... We’ve completely redesigned the widgets interface (which we didn’t have time to do in 2.7) to allow you to do things like edit widgets on-the-fly, have multiple copies of the same widget, drag and drop widgets between sidebars, and save inactive widgets so you don’t lose all their settings. Developers now have access to a much cleaner and robust API for creating widgets as well,” Mullenweg wrote in his official WordPress.org blog. “Finally you should explore the new Screen Options on every page... Now, for example, if you have a wide monitor, you could set up your dashboard to have four columns of widgets instead of the two it has by default. On other pages you can change how many items show per page.”

Firefox 3.5 RC2 released

The Mozilla developers have announced the second release candidate of Firefox 3.5. New features and changes in this milestone include: support for over 70 languages; improved tools to control a user’s private data, including a Private Browsing Mode; support for the HTML5 <video> and <audio> elements, including native support for Ogg Theora encoded video and Vorbis encoded audio, and better performance and stability with the new TraceMonkey JavaScript engine. Version 3.5 also has the ability to provide Location Aware Browsing using Web standards for geolocation; support for native JSON, and Web worker threads; improvements to the Gecko layout engine, including speculative parsing for faster content rendering; support for new Web technologies such as downloadable fonts, CSS media queries, new transformations and properties, JavaScript query selectors, HTML5 local storage and offline application storage, <canvas> text, ICC profiles, and SVG transforms. Those who can’t wait for the final version can grab it from www.mozilla.com/en-US/firefox/all-rc.html.

Wind River Hypervisor for multi-core device development

Wind River has released a hypervisor, which it claims to be “...a key pillar of Wind River’s comprehensive Multicore Software Solution for device development.” The Wind River Hypervisor is a Type-1 hypervisor that supports virtualisation on single and multi-core processors. It provides integration with Wind River’s operating systems (VxWorks and Wind River Linux), as well as others. The new hypervisor enables virtualisation for devices

across a broad range of market segments, including aerospace and defence, automotive, consumer devices, industrial, and networking. Its key features include: support for single and multi-core processors; focus on real-time aspects such as performance, latency, determinism and minimal footprint; protection between operating systems and cores, including starting, stopping and reloading operating systems to increase reliability.

Safetrix: A hosted, free e-mail security service

Safetrix is a hosted e-mail security service that has been launched in India. It claims to offer 100 per cent virus protection and 99 per cent spam protection. The service offers seven different layers of spam protection that include: IP checks, HELO checks, selective greylisting, sender address/domain verification, recipient address/domain verification, in-house blacklist checks, and content checks. The good part is that being a hosted service, no hardware/software are required from the user side. It claims compatibility with all modern e-mail servers’ including Qmail, Sendmail, Postfix, Lotus Notes and Exchange Server, as well as with hosting services like Yahoo! and Gmail. The three-step set-up process includes: registering and creating an account using an automated process; adding domains,

corresponding delivery records and user names; and changing the MX record for the domain.

Safetrix is offered in two flavours, the standard and premium service. The former is absolutely free of cost with no compromises

on e-mail security. The premium service offers additional peace of mind through compliance with industry standards (HIPAA, GLB) and a 100 per cent service-level agreement warranty. For more details visit www.safetrix.com.

